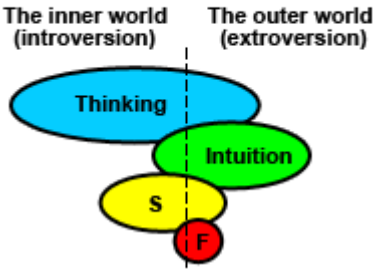


Cognitive Functions

Cognitive functions are the technical term for “Modes of processing information and making decisions based on your Myers-Briggs type.” Each type has four (out of a possible eight) cognitive functions, which they use in a specific order. Identifying which functions you use – and in what order – is the most accurate way to type yourself or anyone else.

INTP Functions

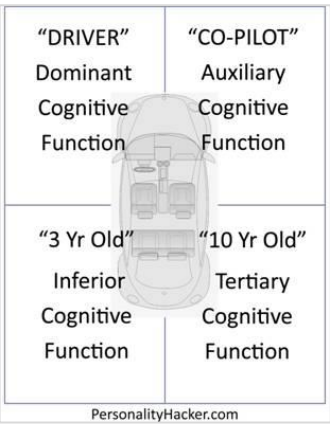
INTP Primary Processes



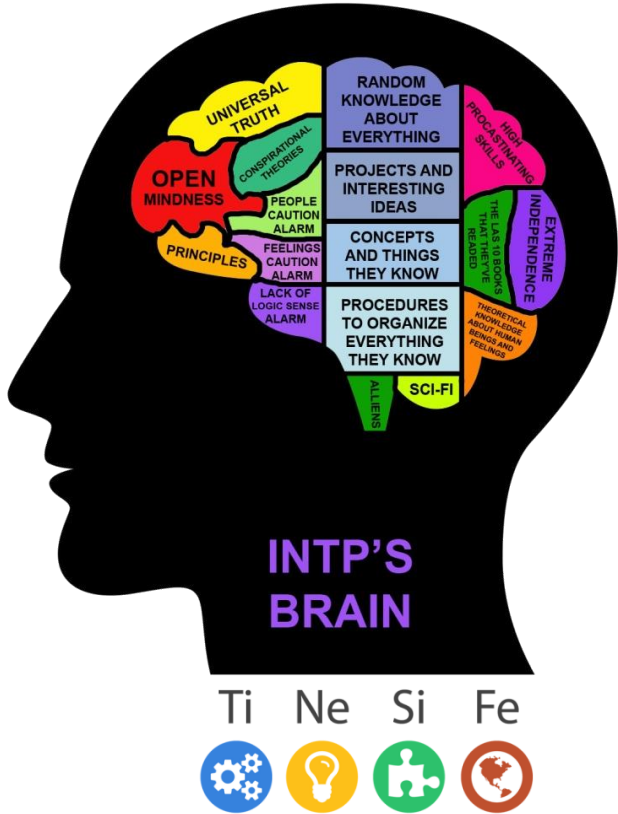
Role	Process	Snapshot
Leading “Driver”	Introverted Thinking	Analysing, categorising, and evaluating according to principles
Supportive “Co-Pilot”	Extroverted iNtuition	Interpreting situations and relationships and pickup meanings and interconnections to other contexts
Relief “10 year old”	Introverted Sensing	Reviewing and recalling past experiences and seeking detailed data
Aspirational “3 year old”	Extroverted Feeling	Connecting and considering others and the group

The analogy of a car is a useful model when thinking about cognitive functions. The first function is the 'driver' of the personality type and is the function from which perspective of all of the other functions follow. It provides the direction and speed. The second function is the 'co-pilot', which navigates around or through any difficulties encountered. The inferior, or 3 year old, function attempts to distract both primary and secondary functions whereas the tertiary function, or '10 year old', only distracts the current dominant function.

Understanding cognitive functions is imperative to understanding type. The four-letter dichotomies cannot possibly explain the complexity of our personalities – we are all thinkers, feelers, sensors and intuitives in various situations. The cognitive functions allow us to understand when we use each function and how it impacts our decision-making process.



The Cognitive Functions



Role	Process	Snapshot
Ne	Extroverted Intuition	How do concepts happen outside me?
Ni	Introverted Intuition	How do concepts happen within me?
Fe	Extroverted Feeling	How does this make others feel?
Fi	Introverted Feeling	Experiencing and acting in the immediate context.
Te	Extroverted Thinking	How does this logically affect things.
Ti	Introverted Thinking	How does this logically affect me?
Se	Extroverted Sensing	How is the environment outside me?
Si	Introverted Sensing	How is the environment inside me?

CONCLUSION

INTP Engineers are highly intellectual people that are driven toward self-mastery and competency. INTPs are their own harshest critics.

Their greatest contribution is the design of sophisticated models and theories that improve the lives of others.



What is MBTI?

Myers-Briggs Type Indicator (MBTI) is a tool that helps people gain insights about themselves and how they interact with others—and improve how they communicate, learn, and work.

Often referred to as a 'personality test', MBTI actually has less to do with one's personality and everything to do with how their brain works from receiving and processing external information to communication preferences. These preferences are split into four pairs – I/E, S/N, F/T and J/P. Though everyone is unique and will have some traits of all 8 letters, people will often be more inclined towards one letter in each pair. By determining your preference in each group, and putting these four letters together, you get your personality **type code** – for you, this is **INTP**.

INTP – The Thinker

What does that mean?

Introverted	Energised by quiet time alone
iNtuitive	Sees patterns and possibilities
Thinking	Prioritises logic and reason
Perceiving	Prefers freedom and flexibility

INTPs are philosophical innovators, fascinated by logical analysis, systems, and design. They are preoccupied with theory, and search for the universal law behind everything they see. They want to understand the unifying themes of life, in all their complexity.

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They want to understand the unifying themes of life, in all their complexity.

INTPs pride themselves on their inventiveness and creativity, their unique perspective and vigorous intellect. Usually known as the philosopher, the architect, or the dreamy professor, INTPs have been responsible for many scientific discoveries throughout history. They love patterns, and spotting discrepancies between statements could almost be described as a hobby, making it a bad idea to lie to an INTP.

No one is more enthusiastic and capable of spotting a problem, drilling through the endless factors and details that encompass the issue and developing a unique and viable solution than INTPs – just don't expect punctual progress reports. When they find an environment where their creative genius and potential can be expressed, there is no limit to the time and energy INTPs will expend in developing an insightful and unbiased solution.

Strengths

- **Great Analysts and Abstract Thinkers** – Views the world as a big, complex machine, and recognises that all parts are interrelated. INTPs excel in analysing these connections.
- **Imaginative and Original** – With unrelenting imagination, the INTPs' ideas may seem counter-intuitive at a glance, but they will always prove remarkable innovations.
- **Open-Minded** – Highly receptive to alternate theories, so long as they're supported by logic and facts.
- **Enthusiastic** – When a new idea piques their interest, INTPs can be very enthusiastic.
- **Objective** – Supported by analysis, creativity and open-mindedness, INTPs are like a conduit for the truths around them, so far as they can be expressed.
- **Honest and Straightforward** – INTPs don't often go around intentionally hurting feelings, but they believe that the truth is the most important factor, and they expect that to be appreciated and reciprocated.

Weaknesses

- **Very Private and Withdrawn** – While INTPs' intellectualism yields many insights into their surroundings, their surroundings are ironically considered an intrusion on their thoughts.
- **Insensitive** – Oftentimes INTPs get so caught up in their logic that they forget any kind of emotional consideration.
- **Absent-minded** – When INTPs' interest is captured, they can become forgetful, missing even the obvious if it's unrelated to their current infatuation.
- **Condescending** – INTPs take pride in their knowledge and rationale, and enjoy sharing their ideas, but in trying to explain how they got from A to B to Z, they can get frustrated.
- **Loathe Rules and Guidelines** – These social struggles are partly a product of INTPs' desire to bypass the rules, of social conduct and otherwise.
- **Second-Guess Themselves** – INTPs remain so open to new information that they often never commit to a decision at all.

